

Axiom AI Technologies

BCP/DR Testing & Lessons Learned

Document ID: AAX-BCP-LL-001

Version: 1.0

Status: Post-Exercise Testing and Continual Improvement Record

Classification: Internal / Portfolio Case Study

1. Document Control

Field	Value
Document Owner	Business Continuity / Information Security Lead
Approver	Executive Management
Related Exercise	AAX-BCP-TTX-001 — BCP/DR Tabletop Exercise
Exercise Scenario	Critical AWS RDS PostgreSQL Database Failure
Exercise Type	Scenario-Based Tabletop Exercise
Review Frequency	After each exercise and at least annually

2. Purpose

This document records the testing outcomes, lessons learned, identified gaps, and improvement actions resulting from the Axiom AI Technologies Business Continuity and Disaster Recovery tabletop exercise.

The purpose is to convert exercise observations into documented corrective actions and continual-improvement activities.

The document provides evidence that the organization's continuity and recovery arrangements are periodically tested and reviewed rather than maintained solely as documented plans.

3. Testing Objectives

The exercise and subsequent review are intended to:

- Determine whether the BCP and DRP can be practically followed during a significant technology disruption.
 - Evaluate the clarity of roles and responsibilities.
 - Evaluate escalation and decision-making processes.
 - Assess communication and stakeholder-management procedures.
 - Evaluate application of RTO, RPO, and MTPD requirements.
 - Identify gaps in recovery procedures and dependencies.
 - Identify documentation or process weaknesses.
 - Capture participant and facilitator observations.
 - Establish corrective actions for identified weaknesses.
 - Define how corrective actions will be validated.
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4. Test Summary

Field	Result
Test Date	To be completed when exercise is conducted
Exercise Duration	Approximately 90 minutes
Exercise Scenario	Production AWS RDS PostgreSQL database failure
Exercise Method	Discussion-based tabletop
Production Impact	None — simulated exercise
Participants	To be completed
Facilitator	To be completed
Overall Result	To be determined
Follow-Up Review Required	

5. Testing Scope

The test evaluates continuity and recovery activities from initial incident recognition through:

1. Incident declaration
2. Initial technical assessment
3. Business impact assessment
4. Continuity activation
5. Escalation

6. Recovery decision-making
7. Communications
8. Technical recovery
9. Recovery validation
10. Transition toward normal operations
11. Post-incident review

The exercise does not involve destructive testing or actual modification of production systems.

Technical recovery procedures may require separate controlled technical validation where appropriate.

6. Testing Approach

The exercise uses a scenario-based tabletop format.

Participants are presented with a simulated production database failure and receive additional information through timed scenario injects.

Participants are expected to explain what they would do using the approved BCP, DRP, recovery runbooks, and applicable incident-management procedures.

The facilitator records:

- Decisions
- Assumptions
- Delays
- Questions
- Documentation gaps
- Communication issues
- Recovery concerns
- Escalation issues
- Corrective-action opportunities

The objective is not to achieve a perfect exercise outcome.

Identifying weaknesses is an intended and valuable result of testing.

7. What Worked Well

This section should be completed during the post-exercise hotwash.

Areas to consider include:

- Clear incident ownership
- Clear escalation paths
- Availability of required documentation
- Usability of the BCP
- Usability of the DRP
- Understanding of critical business activities
- Understanding of system dependencies
- Communication procedures
- Executive decision-making
- Recovery procedures
- RTO/RPO/MTPD awareness
- Recovery validation procedures

Recorded Observations

Observation 1:

Observation 2:

Observation 3:

Observation 4:

8. What Did Not Work / What Was Unclear

This section records weaknesses, ambiguities, delays, assumptions, or process conflicts identified during the exercise.

Finding ID	Observation / Gap	Business Impact	Source
LL-001	To be completed after exercise	To be assessed	Facilitator / Participant
LL-002	To be completed after exercise	To be assessed	Facilitator / Participant
LL-003	To be completed after exercise	To be assessed	Facilitator / Participant

Potential areas include:

- Missing information
- Unclear ownership
- Missing contacts
- Incomplete recovery steps
- Conflicting documentation
- Unclear escalation thresholds
- Insufficient communication procedures
- Recovery dependencies
- Backup or restore assumptions
- Insufficient validation procedures

9. RTO, RPO, and MTPD Observations

The exercise should evaluate whether participants understood and appropriately applied the organization's established recovery objectives.

Participants should use the approved values contained within the BIA, BCP/DR Strategy, BCP, and DRP.

Area	Observation	Assessment	Action Required
RTO	To be completed	Clear / Unclear / Gap	To be determined
RPO	To be completed	Clear / Unclear / Gap	To be determined
MTPD	To be completed	Clear / Unclear / Gap	To be determined
RTO vs. MTPD relationship	To be completed	Clear / Unclear / Gap	To be determined

RTO Assessment

Document whether participants understood the target time for restoration and whether the exercise demonstrated that the documented RTO is achievable under the scenario.

RPO Assessment

Document whether participants understood the acceptable amount of data loss and whether available recovery points support the documented RPO.

MTPD Assessment

Document whether participants understood the maximum tolerable disruption period and how it differs from the RTO.

Relationship Assessment

Document whether participants understood that:

RTO is a recovery target, while MTPD represents the maximum period of disruption the business can tolerate.

The RTO should therefore support recovery before the MTPD is reached.

10. Roles, Escalation, and Decision-Making

Assess whether participants understood who was responsible for technical, operational, and executive decisions.

Area	Observation	Finding
Incident declaration	To be completed	
Incident leadership	To be completed	
Business continuity escalation	To be completed	
Executive approval	To be completed	
Risk acceptance	To be completed	
Potential data-loss decision	To be completed	
Incident closure authority	To be completed	

Specific questions to evaluate:

- Was the incident declared at the appropriate point?
- Was ownership immediately clear?
- Were escalation thresholds understood?

- Was executive authority clearly defined?
 - Were recovery decisions appropriately documented?
 - Was risk acceptance required?
 - Was authority to close the incident understood?
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11. Communications and Stakeholder Management

Evaluate whether participants understood communication responsibilities and notification criteria.

Communication Area	Observation	Improvement Needed
Internal incident communications	To be completed	
Executive communications	To be completed	
Customer communications	To be completed	
Vendor communications	To be completed	
Legal / regulatory assessment	To be completed	
Incident closure communication	To be completed	

The exercise should distinguish between:

- Internal operational communications
- Executive communications
- Customer communications
- Vendor communications
- Contractual notifications
- Legal/regulatory assessments

The existence of a service disruption should not automatically be treated as proof that an external regulatory notification is required. Notification decisions should be based on the facts of the incident and applicable requirements.

12. Recovery and Technical Procedure Findings

Evaluate the practical usability of the DRP and associated recovery runbooks.

Finding ID	Recovery Area	Observation	Required Improvement
REC-001	Recovery initiation	To be completed	
REC-002	Backup / restore	To be completed	
REC-003	Data validation	To be completed	
REC-004	Application validation	To be completed	
REC-005	Monitoring / alerting	To be completed	
REC-006	Return to normal operations	To be completed	

Areas to consider include:

- Recovery prerequisites
- Backup availability
- Recovery-point selection
- Database restoration
- Application dependencies
- Authentication dependencies
- Network dependencies
- Monitoring
- Logging
- Security validation
- Data integrity
- Application functionality
- Business-process validation
- Return-to-normal procedures

13. Lessons Learned

The following sections should be completed following the exercise hotwash.

Lesson 1

Observation:

To be completed after exercise.

Implication:

To be completed after exercise.

Recommended Improvement:

To be completed after exercise.

Lesson 2

Observation:

To be completed after exercise.

Implication:

To be completed after exercise.

Recommended Improvement:

To be completed after exercise.

Lesson 3

Observation:

To be completed after exercise.

Implication:

To be completed after exercise.

Recommended Improvement:

To be completed after exercise.

Lesson 4

Observation:

To be completed after exercise.

Implication:

To be completed after exercise.

Recommended Improvement:

To be completed after exercise.

Lesson 5

Observation:

To be completed after exercise.

Implication:

To be completed after exercise.

Recommended Improvement:

To be completed after exercise.

14. Corrective Action and Improvement Register

All material findings should be converted into actionable improvements.

Action ID	Finding / Lesson	Corrective Action	Owner	Priority	Target Date	Status	Validation
CA-001	To be completed	To be completed	To be assigned	To be assigned	To be assigned	Open	Required
CA-002	To be completed	To be completed	To be assigned	To be assigned	To be assigned	Open	Required
CA-003	To be completed	To be completed	To be assigned	To be assigned	To be assigned	Open	Required
CA-004	To be completed	To be completed	To be assigned	To be assigned	To be assigned	Open	Required

Each corrective action should identify:

- The problem being addressed
 - The required improvement
 - An accountable owner
 - A target completion date
 - Priority
 - Current status
 - Required validation evidence
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15. Corrective Action Prioritization

Corrective actions should be prioritized according to potential business impact, risk exposure, recovery capability, contractual or regulatory considerations, and implementation requirements.

High

A significant gap that could materially impair continuity or recovery capability.

Medium

A meaningful weakness requiring planned remediation but not expected to immediately prevent recovery.

Low

A documentation, optimization, or minor process improvement that does not materially affect recovery capability.

Priority should be reassessed if new information changes the risk associated with an identified finding.

16. Corrective Action Validation

Closing a corrective action requires evidence that the improvement was implemented and, where appropriate, tested for effectiveness.

Examples of validation evidence include:

- Updated BCP
- Updated DRP
- Updated recovery runbook
- Updated contact information
- Completed technical test
- Backup/restore validation
- Updated communication procedure
- Training completion
- Subsequent tabletop exercise
- Subsequent technical recovery test
- Evidence demonstrating that the original gap no longer exists

Action ID	Evidence Required	Validation Method	Validated By	Validation Date	Result
CA-001	To be completed	Review / Test / Exercise	To be assigned		
CA-002	To be completed	Review / Test / Exercise	To be assigned		
CA-003	To be completed	Review / Test / Exercise	To be assigned		

An action should not be marked fully closed solely because a document was changed when the underlying issue requires operational or technical validation.

17. Document and ISMS Updates

Where testing identifies weaknesses in controlled documentation, the appropriate document should be updated through the organization's document-control process.

Potential updates may include:

- Business Impact Analysis
- BCP/DR Strategy
- Business Continuity Plan
- Disaster Recovery Plan
- Recovery runbooks
- Incident Response documentation
- Risk Register
- Training or awareness materials
- Third-party dependency documentation

Where an exercise identifies a previously unknown risk, the risk should also be evaluated through the organization's risk-management process.

18. Overall Testing Conclusion

The overall conclusion should be completed after the tabletop exercise and hotwash.

The conclusion should summarize:

- Overall effectiveness of the tested arrangements
- Significant strengths

- Material weaknesses
- Recovery capability observations
- RTO/RPO/MTPD observations
- Corrective actions required
- Required management attention

Conclusion:

19. Management Review and Follow-Up

Material findings and overdue corrective actions should be presented to appropriate management and tracked through the organization's risk, compliance, or continual-improvement process.

Management review should confirm:

- Action ownership
- Priority
- Target dates
- Required resources
- Residual risk
- Risk acceptance where applicable
- Validation requirements
- Closure criteria

Corrective actions should remain open until appropriate evidence demonstrates that the identified issue has been addressed.

20. Relationship to Project 4

This document represents the final improvement stage of the Project 4 continuity lifecycle:

Business Impact Analysis → BCP/DR Strategy → Business Continuity Plan → Disaster Recovery Plan → Tabletop Exercise → Testing & Lessons Learned

The purpose of this final stage is to ensure that lessons from testing feed back into the organization's continuity, recovery, risk-management, and ISMS processes.

21. Document Control

Version	Date	Owner	Change
1.0	2026-10-03	Business Continuity / Information Security Lead	Initial testing and lessons-learned document for portfolio case study

Review Frequency: After each continuity/disaster recovery exercise and at least annually.

The document should also be updated following:

- A material incident
- Significant changes to critical systems
- Changes to critical dependencies
- Changes to RTO/RPO/MTPD requirements
- Material changes to the BCP or DRP
- Significant changes to the organization's continuity arrangements